

LDT4SSC Project Methodology

Step 2: VALIDATE (Specifications)

Data Governance Workshop

**Workshop: Complementing your
Data Governance Roadmap with
a Legal Framework: From
Mapping Legal Phases to Action**

May 2026

Authors: Cerema



Document History

Date	Version	Edited by	Description
May 2026	v1	Marine Le Gall, Laura Riou, Sophie Houzet	First version adapted from the CAPACities program.

Workshop Overview

Title	Complementing your Data Governance Roadmap with a Legal Framework: From Mapping Legal Phases to Action
Methodological step	Step 2: VALIDATE (Specifications)
Duration	2 hours and 30 mins
Number of Facilitators	1 for each group of 4 to 5 people
Equipment Needed	• One big sheet of paper (1m/2m) or a large (digital) whiteboard • Sticky notes • Pens and markers
Expected outputs	• Visual map of project legal phases and associated actions • An initial legal framework integrated into the data-governance roadmap • A summary note produced after the workshop, outlining key findings and next steps.

Copyright Message

This document is intended for the LDT4SSC consortium, pilot teams and the public use, providing guidance to support the consistent implementation of LDT4SSC pilot activities.



This work is licensed by Cerema under the Creative Commons Attribution-NonCommercial-ShareAlike 4.0 International License. To view a copy of this license, visit <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by-nc-sa/4.0/>

Table of contents

1. Context and objectives.....	4
2. Workshop.....	4
2.1. Workshop phases overview.....	4
2.2. Workshop step by step guide.....	5
Phase 0: Framing and Icebreaker (recommended allocated time: 15 mins).....	5
Phase 1: Identifying Project Legal Phases (recommended allocated time: 45 mins)...	5
Figure 1. Phases of a project from a Legal point of view (Source: LDT4SSC).	5
Phase 2: Focusing on each Identified Phase (recommended allocated time: 1 hour)..	6
Phase 3: Summarising findings and Defining Next Steps (recommended allocated time: 30 mins).....	7
2.3. Recommendations for Workshop facilitation.....	7
3. Next steps.....	8

1. Context and objectives

The **Complementing your Data Governance Roadmap with a Legal Framework** workshop is part of the **VALIDATE step (specification)** which bridges the gap between the project's initial idea and its practical implementation. It translates the use cases into **technical and functional requirements**, while accounting for real-world constraints such as interoperability, data, architecture, security, and putting the user's needs at the center.

More information on the objectives, prerequisites and stakeholders to involve in the EXPLORE step can be found on the LDT4SSC Knowledge Hub¹.

The workshop is designed to achieve the following objectives:

- **Understand the legal phases** of the LDT project.
- **Align participants** on the legal framework for a successful project implementation.
- Enrich the governance roadmap with **legal and regulatory requirements**.
- Identify **areas that require further exploration** and discussion.

2. Workshop

2.1. Workshop phases overview

<i>Time spent</i>	<i>Phase</i>	<i>Description</i>
15 mins	0. Framing and Icebreaker	Participants are reminded of the chosen use case and the objectives of the project in order to anchor the reflection in a concrete context.
45 mins	1. Identifying Project Legal Phases	Participants map all legal stages of their project on a large circle on paper, while the facilitator may display technical stage diagrams for reference.
1 hour	2. Focusing on each Identified Stage	Participants analyse each legal stage, considering necessary clauses and contractual agreements, use circles to capture initial legal actions, and refer to a methodological guide for key questions.
30 mins	3. Synthesising Legal Insights and Defining Actionable Next Phases	Participants transform the workshop's legal insights into a structured roadmap, ensuring every phase of the project is compliant, actionable, and aligned with stakeholder responsibilities.

2.2. Workshop step by step guide

Phase 0: Framing and Icebreaker (recommended allocated time: 15 mins)

The facilitator orients the participants **towards the selected use case** and the overarching project objectives. They list all **relevant project factors** such as: goals, stakeholders, budget. This initial phase ensures that the subsequent discussions remain grounded in a **clear and concrete context**. It also serves to **align all stakeholders** on the purpose, scope,

¹ https://knowledgehub.ldt4ssc.eu/resources_content/methodology/

The facilitator also **organises an icebreaker** designed to foster mental and creative engagement by encouraging participants to adopt a playful, and open mindset. This initial interactive, game-like activity, stimulates imaginative thinking, reduces initial social tension, and prepares participants to engage fully in subsequent workshop phases.

The goal of this phase is to **identify all legal phases** of the project, from initial conception through to deployment and scaling, ensuring comprehensive coverage of legal and regulatory considerations.

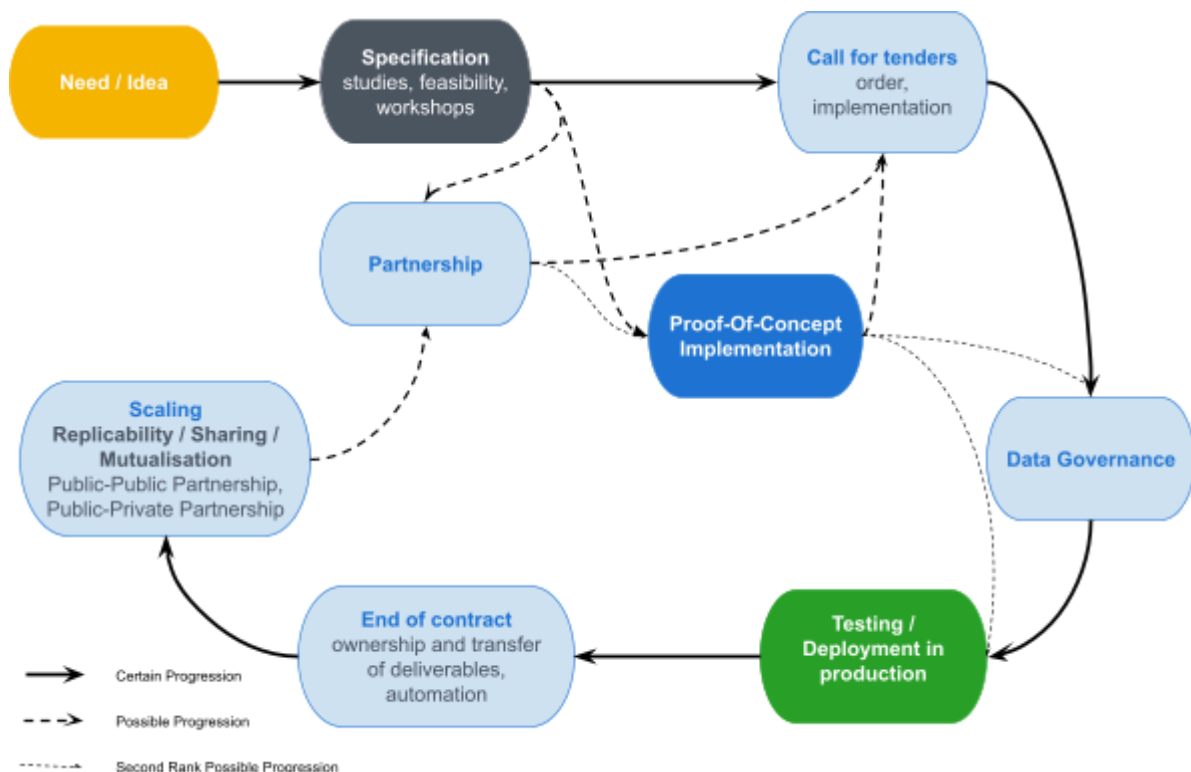


Figure 1 presents the legal phases of a typical project lifecycle, mirroring the operational and technical steps of the [LDT4SSC Methodology](#). These legal phases complement the project-level steps of the methodology: (1) Explore – Ideation, (2) Validate – Specification, (3) Define – Prototype, and (4) Implement – Deployment. Project legal milestones — such as implementing a call for tenders, partnering up, setting proper data governance, the end of a legal contract, or mutualising a platform — are typical legal phases of a project.

To do so, participants collaboratively **position each legal phase** around a **large circle** drawn on paper, with each phase enclosed in a **rectangle** for clarity. A reference diagram of potential **technical project stages** and the **data-governance roadmap** from the previous workshops may be displayed to provide context and guide the discussion.

The facilitator **guides participants** in identifying and listing all potential legal phases, offering **clarifications** where needed and ensuring that **diverse perspectives**—including technical, operational, and governance viewpoints—are fully considered.

Phase 2: Focusing on each Identified Phase (recommended allocated time: 1 hour)

In this phase, the objective is to **conduct a detailed analysis of the legal and contractual requirements** associated with each phase of the project. Participants will systematically examine each phase to determine the **necessary legal actions**, such as drafting specific clauses or establishing contractual agreements —covering aspects like **open regulatory constraints, data policies, confidentiality obligations, and intellectual property rights**. Key questions will guide the discussion, such as:

Examples of questions for each identified phase

- Is the data intended for use **openly accessible**, or will **agreements with public or private actors** be required?
- Have **confidentiality clauses** already been established between partners, or do they need to be formalised?
- What contributions will each party provide, and what are their respective responsibilities?
- Will **intellectual property rights** be transferred on a **non-exclusive basis**, allowing all parties to exploit the results, or will exploitation be restricted to a single consortium member?
- If restricted, what **long-term benefits** might local authorities gain from their collaboration with the company?

Each identified legal action will be **visually represented in a circle adjacent to its corresponding project phase**, using **the questions and the methodological guide** (available in the **LDT4SSC Knowledge Hub**) to support reflection.

The facilitator will **guide discussions, provide relevant examples, and ensure that all critical questions are addressed**, helping participants reach a **consensus on the project's legal direction**. This process ensures **alignment on contractual terms** and highlights areas requiring further exploration or clarification.

Phase 3: Summarising findings and Defining Next Steps (recommended allocated time: 30 mins)

This final phase focuses on **consolidating the legal phases and requirements** identified throughout the session into a **clear, structured action plan**. The facilitator will begin by **summarising the key findings** of the workshop.

To ensure that the workshop's insights are **actionable and practical**, the facilitator will guide participants in **developing a concise legal framework**. It should outline the **specific legal actions required** at each project stage. The framework should also **assign responsibilities** to relevant stakeholders, ensuring accountability and clarity as the project progresses. Additionally, the facilitator will **highlight any gaps or unresolved questions** that emerged during the discussions, proposing a **process for follow-up** to address these areas, whether through further legal consultation, stakeholder engagement, or additional research.

The facilitator will collect **commitments** from participants to **adhere to the defined legal framework** and **integrate the workshop's outcomes** into the broader data-governance roadmap. This phase ensures that the **legal considerations are not only documented but also embedded** into the project's operations.

Finally, the session will close with the facilitator **outlining the next steps**, including **scheduled reviews and progress check-ins** to ensure that the legal framework remains **adaptive and aligned** with the project's evolution and the consortium's expectations.

2.3. Recommendations for Workshop facilitation

To ensure the workshop's effectiveness, facilitators are advised to adopt the following approaches:

Utilise Visual Tools to Clarify Legal Concepts

To enhance comprehension, facilitators ought to **leverage visual aids**, such as **circles, rectangles, and diagrams**, to **represent legal phases, actions, and relationships**. By transforming **abstract legal concepts into tangible visual elements**, participants can more easily **grasp complex requirements and dependencies**, leading to a more effective and collaborative analysis.

Adhere to the Methodological Guide for Systematic Analysis

Facilitators must **consistently refer to the methodological guide** throughout the workshop to **systematically address all critical legal considerations**. This structured approach ensures that **no essential legal aspects**, including **compliance, contractual obligations, or intellectual property**, are overlooked, thereby maintaining **focus and rigour** in the discussion.

Document Agreements and Uncertainties for Accountability

It is essential to **encourage participants to clearly record** all **agreements reached**, as well as any **unresolved questions or uncertainties**. This documentation provides a **valuable reference** for **follow-up actions**, ensuring **accountability and continuity** in the development and refinement of the project's legal framework.

Contextualise Discussions with Practical Examples

Facilitators should **incorporate real-world examples and case studies** from previous experiences to **ground discussions in practical realities**. This method helps participants **connect theoretical legal requirements to practical implementation**, thereby enhancing the **relevance and applicability** of the workshop's outcomes.

3. Next steps

Once the use case is defined, it is time to specify it in greater depth. To achieve this, one may use workshops from this specification step or move on to workshops from the next step.

The following workshops for the VALIDATE step are:

- *2.2.5 Refining your Legal Framework for Data Governance: Deep dive into legal and contractual requirements*
- *2.3 Inventorying your LDT Project Data: Unlocking Interoperability, Listing and committing to share data among partners*
- *2.4 Identifying Levers, Obstacles and Objectives for Interoperability: From Awareness to Actionable Strategies for LDT Projects*
- *Bonus: Lego® Serious Play: A Transversal Tool to Address and Overcome Data Governance Challenges*

NB: The *Bonus: Lego® Serious Play* workshop is a workshop aimed at unwrapping bottlenecks via the usage of Legos, so it can be paired with any and all workshops in the VALIDATE step.

Next Methodology steps:

- *Done: Complete the EXPLORE workshops*
- *Ongoing: Complete the VALIDATE workshops*
- *Complete the DEFINE workshops*
- *Complete the IMPLEMENT workshops*

Disclaimer

The content of this report reflects only the author's view.
The European Commission is not responsible for any use that may be made of the information it contains.

